

RSS Feeds on Moodle

Using the **Remote RSS Feeds** block, you can embed live-updating news on your Moodle page. An example of this is CBC News – you can embed current news in your Moodle page. You can also set up RSS feeds of blogs (including your own), which makes it easy for you to share interesting links and stories on Moodle and increase engagement.

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Find an RSS feed

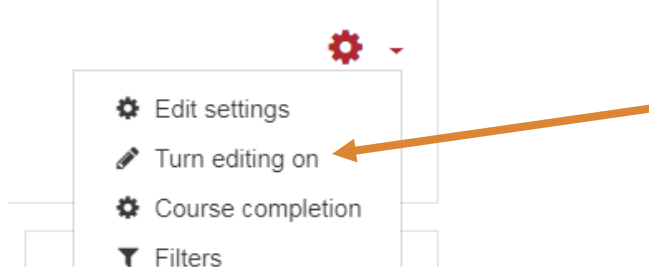
Many websites with content that updates regularly, like news sites or blogs, will support RSS feeds.

1. Go to a website that supports RSS feeds. If a website supports RSS, it will have the following logo somewhere on the page: 
2. RSS Feeds have their own special URL links. There will be different instructions on the type of link the RSS feed will have, so check with the site itself for instructions. For example, a WordPress) RSS Feed URL will have /feed/ at the end of it (eg. <http://moodleblog.wordpress.com/feed/>). On CBC's website, you can find a list of RSS feed links here - <http://www.cbc.ca/rss/>
3. Copy the RSS link you want to add to your Moodle course.

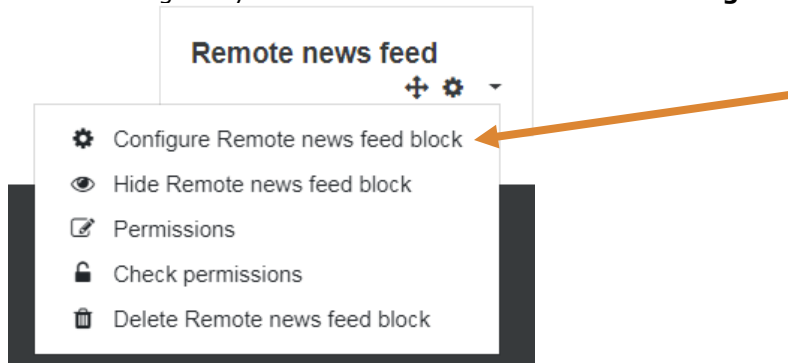
Create a Remote RSS Feeds block

Now it's time to insert the feed into your course page. To do this, Moodle has a block specially made for RSS feeds.

1. On your Moodle course page, **turn editing on** by clicking on the **Settings button** on the right hand side, and selecting **Turn editing on** from the dropdown menu.

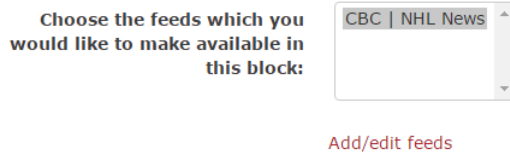


2. Open the Navigation pane if it isn't all ready, and scroll down to the **Add a block** block that appears. Select **Remote RSS feeds** from the popup menu.
3. Click on the gear symbol in the new block and select **Configure Remote news feed block**

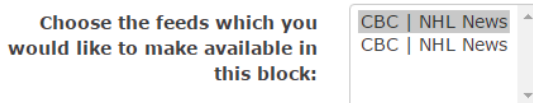


4. The following are the block settings available to you:
 - **Display each link's description?** – you may choose to show just the link to an individual story in your feed, or a full description of each link (including picture, if available). Please be aware that if you choose to show the full description, you will likely want to reduce the number of entries to show on this block, to save space.
 - **Max number entries to show per block.** – changes the number of entries shown in the block. The default is 5 entries.
 - **Choose the feeds which you would like to make available in this block:** - initially, there will be no feeds available in this block, so you will have to add them using the **Add/edit feeds** link (see next step for instructions).
 - **Title** – add a custom title to this block.
 - **Should a link to the original site (channel link) be displayed? (Note that if no feed link is supplied in the news feed then no link will be shown):** - you can choose to have a link to the original website where the entries are located (eg. CBC News).

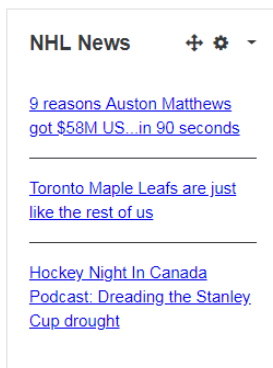
- **Show channel image if available:** - show the logo of the channel in the block (if available).
5. Add a feed and make it available in this block by clicking on the **Add/edit feeds** link under the feeds available:



6. Click on the **Add a new feed** button to add a feed. **NOTE:** Moodle will ask you if you would like to leave this page. Select **leave**. **Make sure you have saved any settings you've changed for this block before doing so.**
7. Paste your RSS feed URL into the **Feed URL** field. You may also choose a custom title for this feed, or leave it blank if you are okay with the default title for that link. Click on **Save changes**.
8. You will need to navigate back to your Remote RSS feed block. Click the name of your course in the breadcrumb trail to get back to the main page of your course. Locate your block, and select **Configure Remote news feed block**.
9. **Select your feed in the available feeds box.** If you do not select your feed (even if there is only one feed available), the RSS feed will not show.



10. Click the **Save changes** button. You should now see a live feed showing up in this block on your course page. The following is an example without the descriptions turned on:



For more information, please contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca